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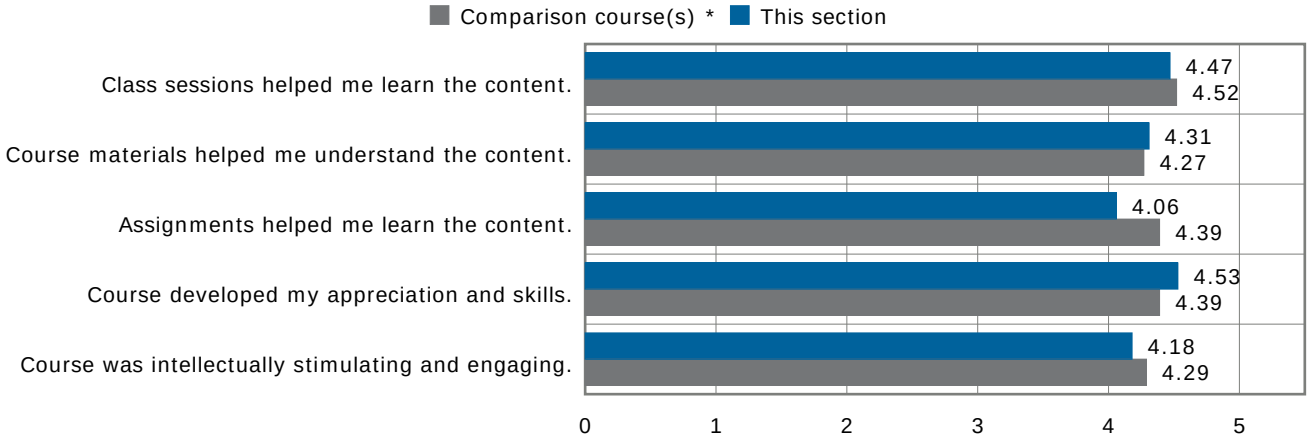
Student Evaluation of Teaching (SET) for Devontae Cortez Baxter

ASTR 20A - Intro to Astrophysics I (Baxter, Devontae)
Fall 2025

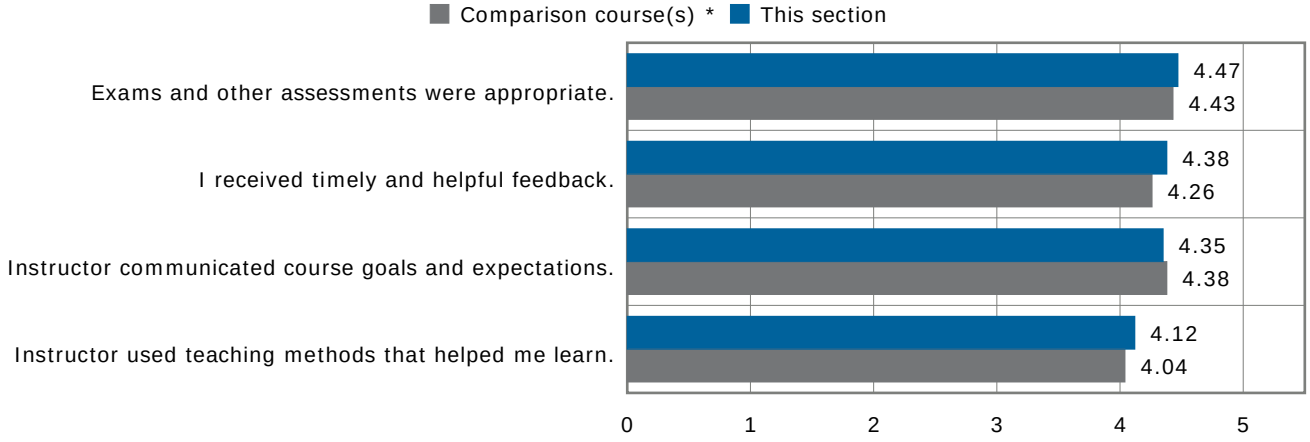
Number of Evaluations Submitted: 17
Number of Students Enrolled: 40

Summary Results

Student Learning

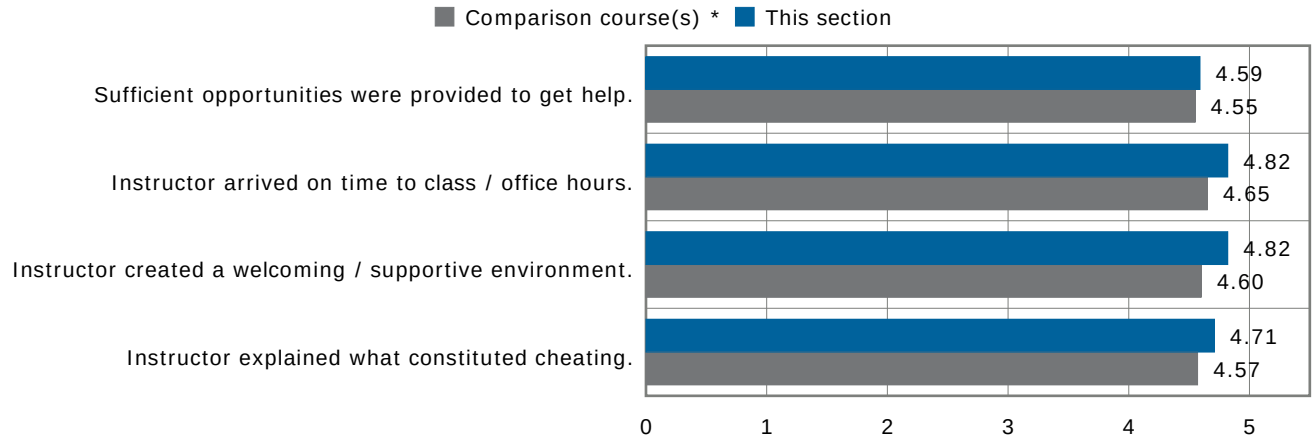


Course Structure

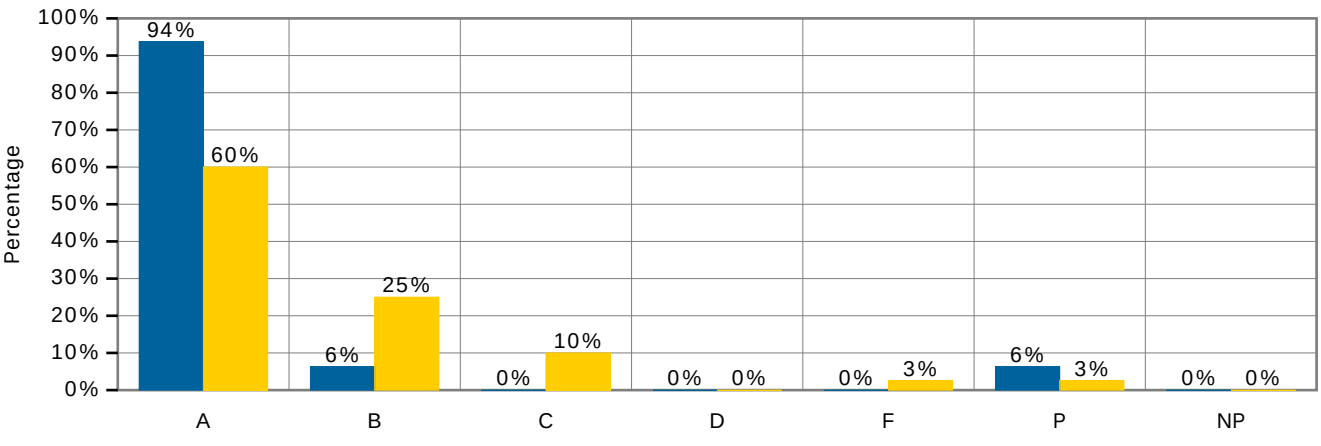


* Comparison courses used: All Astronomy & Astrophysics Fall 2025 LD courses

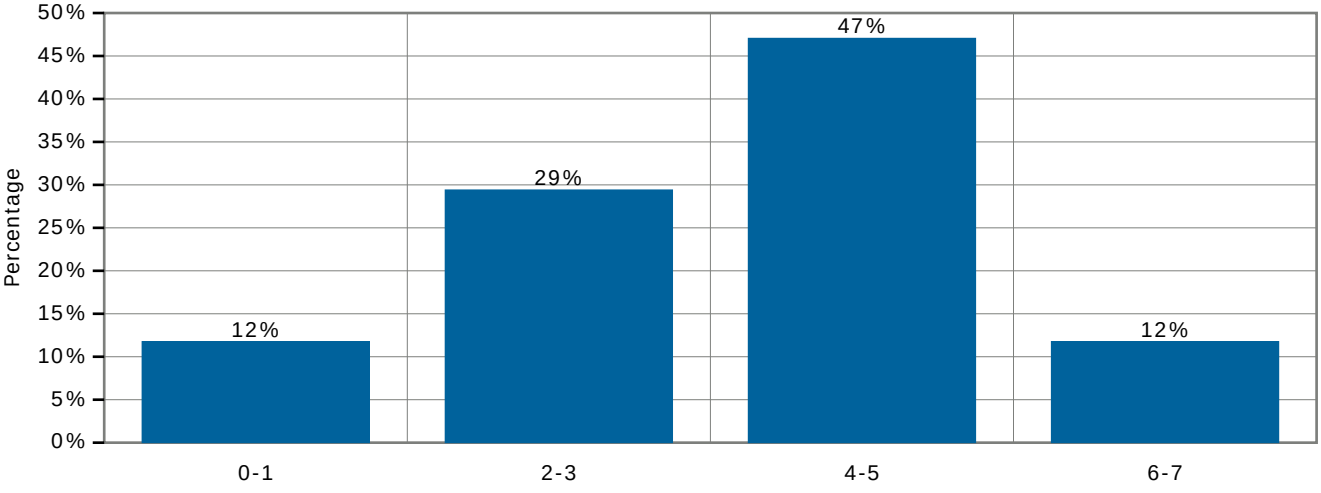
Class Environment



Expected Grade (A- average, 3.94) vs. Grade Received: (B+ average, 3.45)



Hours per week outside of class (4.18 average)



Full Results

Student Learning

1. **Class sessions** helped me learn the course content.

8 (47.1%): Strongly Agree
9 (52.9%): Agree
0 (0.0%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

2. **Course readings and other course materials** helped me learn course content.

8 (47.1%): Strongly Agree
5 (29.4%): Agree
3 (17.6%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
1 (5.9%): No Opinion

3. **Assignments** (homework, projects, etc) helped me learn the course content.

4 (23.5%): Strongly Agree
10 (58.8%): Agree
3 (17.6%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

4. The course **developed** my **appreciation** of and **skills** for the subject.

11 (64.7%): Strongly Agree
4 (23.5%): Agree
2 (11.8%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

5. The course was **intellectually stimulating and engaging**.

6 (35.3%): Strongly Agree
9 (52.9%): Agree
1 (5.9%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
1 (5.9%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

Course Structure

6. The instructor effectively communicated **course goals** , learning **outcomes** , and **expectations**.

6 (35.3%): Strongly Agree
11 (64.7%): Agree
0 (0.0%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

7. **Exams and other assessments** (essays, projects, etc) were an appropriate measure of course learning outcomes.

9 (52.9%): Strongly Agree
7 (41.2%): Agree
1 (5.9%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

8. I received **timely and helpful feedback** in this course.

8 (47.1%): Strongly Agree
6 (35.3%): Agree
2 (11.8%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
1 (5.9%): No Opinion

9. The instructor incorporated **teaching methods** that helped me learn.

5 (29.4%): Strongly Agree
10 (58.8%): Agree
1 (5.9%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
1 (5.9%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

Class Environment

10. There were sufficient **opportunities offered for me to get help** when needed (e.g. established office hours, discussion section, discussion board, etc).

10 (58.8%): Strongly Agree
7 (41.2%): Agree
0 (0.0%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

11. The instructor **arrived on time** to class sessions and office hours.

14 (82.4%): Strongly Agree
3 (17.6%): Agree
0 (0.0%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

12. The instructor created a **welcoming and supportive learning environment** that valued and supported students from all backgrounds and identities.

14 (82.4%): Strongly Agree
3 (17.6%): Agree
0 (0.0%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

13. The instructor explained what constituted cheating in this course and emphasized the importance of **academic integrity**.

12 (70.6%): Strongly Agree
5 (29.4%): Agree
0 (0.0%): Neither Agree Nor Disagree
0 (0.0%): Disagree
0 (0.0%): Strongly Disagree
0 (0.0%): No Opinion

Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that...

14. Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that particularly helped you to engage with the material, learn the material, and/or develop your own critical perspectives on the material.

- Around halfway through the quarter, we filled out a google spreadsheet answering questions about what was working/not working for us as students in the course. I was having trouble connecting the fast-paced slides to the homework as well as understanding what exactly we were learning each day. After recieving feedback from the class, the professor changed the layout of class, implementing daily learning objectives, examples, and time to pause and ask questions. This was helpful!
- Discussion with peers, review sessions in discussion section
- I enjoyed the more interactive aspects of the class - participating in the surveys for the last few lectures, talking with classmates, and interacting with others really helped me to understand the content by repeating it out loud.
- I think that changing up the lectures through feedback was really useful for me.
- The lecture slides include a lot of diagrams that help me to understand the course material effectively. They are generally better compared to the textbook.

15. Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that were less helpful for your learning. Optionally you may offer constructive suggestions that might improve their effectiveness.

- I struggled with connecting the homework to the lecture materials a lot of the time. We would look at an equation once in lecture without really understanding what/how to implement it.
- I think the homework assignments often strayed from what was taught in lecture, and caused me more confusion and frustration than an opportunity for learning. I went to multiple homework sessions, and there were often disagreements between various students about how to do a question since we all found different sources with different answers/measurements. I think tying the homework closer to lecture, or giving more context within the homework itself/providing the necessary measurements/information would help alleviate this greatly.
- Spending large portions of class going through the algebra of long derivations
- The formulae derivations were sometimes a bit confusing. Sometimes the derivations were across multiple slides, but it's easy for people to forget what's on previous slides, so maybe the font size of each line can be reduced, and try to put everything related in one slide. The derivation consistency can be attained.
- The lectures were entirely taken out of the textbook and the professor didn't implement many other lecture techniques besides quoting the textbook. The homework tended to cover mathematical principles while the tests didn't focus on math at all, which was misleading.
- There are a lot of equations too. I know these equations are important but I also need to know the context and how to use them. I think the instructor can explain the equations briefly on the derivations, the meanings and relationships (proportional or inversely proportional) of the variables, and when to use it.

- This was fixed towards end of course, but more interactive lectures with derivations on the board instead of slides.

16. Please describe any specific aspects of the course and/or teaching practices that your instructor used that created or interfered with a welcoming learning environment that valued and supported students from all backgrounds and identities.

- Encouraged group work in class with a think pair share.
- I never felt unwelcome in the class, it was a very friendly environment! I sometimes get nervous in STEM classes as a queer person, but the environment was especially welcoming and approachable this quarter :)
- I there the brain breaks were helpful with both the content and the engagement.
- The in-class discussions are interesting and helpful. We can have our opinions freely since most of them are open-ended.

Student Participation

17. What was/were your reason(s) for taking this course?

13 (54.2%):	Major/Program Requirement
2 (8.3%):	Minor
0 (0.0%):	College General Education
1 (4.2%):	Elective
8 (33.3%):	Interest
0 (0.0%):	American History and Institutions (AHI) Requirement
0 (0.0%):	Undergraduate Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Requirement (DEI) Requirement
0 (0.0%):	Jane Teranes Climate Change Education Requirement (JTCCER)
0 (0.0%):	Graduate Program Requirement
0 (0.0%):	Other

18. How often did you attend class and/or engage with course materials?

11 (64.7%):	Always
6 (35.3%):	Usually
0 (0.0%):	Sometimes
0 (0.0%):	Seldom
0 (0.0%):	Never

19. Hours per week of work outside of class

2 (11.8%):	0-1
5 (29.4%):	2-3
8 (47.1%):	4-5
2 (11.8%):	6-7
0 (0.0%):	8-9
0 (0.0%):	10-11
0 (0.0%):	12-13
0 (0.0%):	14-15
0 (0.0%):	16-17
0 (0.0%):	18-19
0 (0.0%):	20 or more

20. Expected grade in the course

15 (88.2%):	A
1 (5.9%):	B
0 (0.0%):	C
0 (0.0%):	D
0 (0.0%):	F
1 (5.9%):	P
0 (0.0%):	NP

Additional Feedback

21. Is there anything else you would like to share about your experience in the course?

[No Responses]

The data and comments provided in this report are unfiltered and unedited, and do not necessarily reflect the opinions of instructors, the teaching department, Academic Affairs, or UC San Diego. Responses and comments are made available without auditing or editing, and they may not be modified or deleted, to ensure that each evaluator has an opportunity to express their opinion.

Confidential support for reading and interpreting student feedback is available through the Teaching and Learning Commons. Click here to schedule a one-on-one consultation, or email engagedteaching@ucsd.edu.

As a reminder, you will have an opportunity to provide additional context and/or commentary for campus reviewers as part of your teaching statement at the time of your academic review (subject to applicable academic review procedures, policies, and labor agreements).

If you feel that comments constitute harassment or discrimination, then please file a report with the Office for the Prevention of Harassment and Discrimination (OPHD). Because these comments are provided anonymously, it is unlikely that any action can be taken. However, OPHD will record and review these reports in order to assess whether SET comments are a cause for concern.